

Module 7: Migration Through History

Service Learning Project

Migration Memory Project: Local History with a Community Archive

Overview

Partner with a historical society, museum, or immigrant heritage organization to document and present a chapter of your community's migration history — and connect it to today.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe historical migration patterns in your own community (UG 1)
- Compare past and present migration experiences (UG 2)
- Identify how policy shifts shaped local settlement (UG 3)

Suggested community partners

- Local historical societies and museums
- Immigrant heritage and cultural organizations
- Public library local-history rooms
- Oral history projects at community colleges or universities

Project steps

1. Choose, with the partner, one local migration story (a neighborhood, industry, congregation, or family network).
2. Complete oral-history ethics training if interviews are involved (consent forms, ownership of recordings).
3. Research archival sources: newspapers, census records, photographs, institutional records.
4. Conduct 1–2 oral history interviews with elders or descendants where appropriate, following the partner's protocols.
5. Create a public-facing product: exhibit panel, digital story map, annotated photo collection, or program for a heritage event.
6. Present it publicly and write a comparative reflection: what parallels and differences with today's arrivals?

Deliverables

- Public history product (partner keeps)
- Oral history recordings/transcripts per partner protocol (if applicable)
- 3-page past-vs-present comparative reflection

Time commitment

15–18 hours.

Ethics requirements

Oral history consent and ownership follow the partner's protocols; narrators approve their transcripts.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Historical accuracy and source work 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: historical accuracy and source work is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: historical accuracy and source work is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: historical accuracy and source work is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: historical accuracy and source work is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Ethical handling of oral history 20%	Conduct is impeccable: ethical handling of oral history is demonstrated throughout, protocols are followed without exception, and the work shows active care for the people and communities involved.	Conduct is sound: ethical handling of oral history is evident with only minor lapses that do not affect participants or partners, and all required protocols are followed.	Conduct is uneven: ethical handling of oral history is addressed but with gaps — a missed protocol step, careless handling of sensitive material, or boundary issues requiring instructor follow-up.	Conduct falls short of requirements: ethical handling of oral history is neglected in ways that required intervention or placed participants, partners, or material at risk.
Quality of the public product 30%	The deliverable is excellent: quality of the public product is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: quality of the public product is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: quality of the public product is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: quality of the public product is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.
Comparative insight 20%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: comparative insight goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: comparative insight is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: comparative insight is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: comparative insight is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.